

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 914

By Hicks T

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Tracy George Trott of Elizabethton.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Tracy George Trott; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Trott was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born on July 27, 1956, in Augusta, Maine, to Theodore "Ted" Trott and Kathleen "Kay" Trott, Tracy Trott was raised in Randolph, Maine, where his childhood was spent surrounded by friends and family; and

WHEREAS, Tracy Trott was a devoted fan of the Boston Red Sox and Boston Celtics and a passionate athlete, who played basketball, baseball, and golf, forming friendships through sport that endured throughout his life; and

WHEREAS, his commitment to excellence was evident in every aspect of his life, from the organization of his garage to his academic and professional achievements; Mr. Trott received an associate degree, bachelor's degree, and master's degree from East Tennessee State University, where he began his career as a campus police officer in 1976; and

WHEREAS, he was also a graduate of the Northwestern School of Police Staff and Command and the FBI National Executive Institute; and

WHEREAS, Tracy Trott joined the Tennessee Highway Patrol (THP) in 1978 and served for seven years as a Road Trooper, six years as a Sergeant, and fourteen years as a Troop Lieutenant, managing five counties in the Tri-Cities area; he was promoted to Lieutenant Colonel in August 2006 and took the reins of leadership as Colonel in September 2010; and

WHEREAS, Colonel Trott dedicated forty years of exemplary service to the THP before taking his well-deserved retirement in 2018; and

WHEREAS, throughout his long and honorable career, Colonel Trott exemplified unwavering professionalism, pride, and honor; his leadership, commitment to public safety, and devotion to the men and women of the THP left a lasting impact on the agency and all who had the privilege of serving alongside him; and

WHEREAS, with his passion for leadership and safety, Tracy Trott founded a consulting business upon his retirement and continued to work with the law enforcement community; his legacy will live on through the lives of those he encouraged, mentored, and inspired; and

WHEREAS, East Tennessee State University recognized Mr. Trott for his academic excellence and lifelong achievement by naming him Distinguished Major in Law Enforcement by the Criminal Justice faculty in 1976, Distinguished Graduate Student in 1994, and Outstanding Alumni in 2017; and

WHEREAS, a man of abiding faith, Tracy Trott was a member of First Christian Church in Elizabethton for forty years and served as both deacon and elder, offering steady leadership and quiet strength to his congregation; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Trott was also a devoted family man and friend, who relished cheering on the University of Tennessee Volunteers at Neyland Stadium with his loved ones and found joy in the everyday pleasures of life: sports cars, cherries in the summer, new sneakers, barbecue, and landscaping with gusto; his affection for dogs was legendary, and his home was a warm and welcoming place for family and friends, especially during the Fourth of July celebrations he and his wife hosted for many years; and

WHEREAS, left to cherish his memory are his loving wife, Meredith Trott; son, Joey Trott; daughter, Laura Trott, and her husband, Jason Yoo; grandson, Henry Yoo; brother, Tyler Trott, and his wife, Carol; and many beloved nieces, nephews, cousins, and friends; and

WHEREAS, Tracy Trott was preceded in death by his parents; his brother, Timmy Trott; and his sister, Thea Ruth Pierce; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Trott leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Tracy George Trott, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Trott.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.